



SANCHAY

· Inventory & Asset Management System

User Manual · Version 1.0.0

A professional, offline-first desktop application for managing organisational assets — from laptops to lab equipment.

✓ Multi-org & Department Support	✓ Role-Based Access Control
✓ Asset Registration & Tracking	✓ PDF · Excel · CSV Reports
✓ Issue / Return Workflow	✓ Backup & Restore
✓ Audit Trail for Every Action	✓ Keyboard Shortcuts & Search

1. Introduction

Sanchay (संचय, meaning *collection* or *accumulation*) is a professional, offline-first desktop application for tracking and managing organisational assets. It runs entirely on your local machine — no internet connection or cloud account required.

1.1 Key Features

- Multi-organisation and department management
- Asset registration with categories, serial numbers, warranty tracking
- Issue and return workflow with overdue detection
- Employee, Student, Contractor, and Candidate management
- Role-based access control (Admin / Manager / Operator / Viewer)
- PDF, Excel, and CSV reports (6 report types)
- Backup and Restore with WAL-safe SQLite copy
- Immutable audit trail for every action
- Full input validation and security hardening (bcrypt, SQL-injection prevention)

1.2 System Requirements

Component	Minimum
Operating System	Windows 10 / 11 (64-bit)
Processor	Intel Core i3 or equivalent
RAM	4 GB
Disk Space	500 MB free (for application + data)
Display	1280 × 768 or higher resolution

2. Installation

Sanchay is distributed as a single installer file: **SanchaySetup-1.0.0.exe**. No Python or additional runtime is required.

2.1 Running the Installer

- Double-click **SanchaySetup-1.0.0.exe**.
- If Windows SmartScreen appears, click **More info** → **Run anyway**.
- Accept the license agreement and click **Next**.
- Choose the installation folder (default: *C:\Program Files\Sanchay*) and click **Install**.
- Once complete, tick **Launch Sanchay now** and click **Finish**.

2.2 What Gets Installed

- **C:\Program Files\Sanchay\Sanchay.exe** — main application
- **C:\Program Files\Sanchay_internal** — bundled runtime and resources
- Start Menu shortcut: *Sanchay* → *Sanchay*
- Desktop shortcut: *Sanchay*
- Add/Remove Programs entry for clean uninstallation

2.3 Data Location

All user data (database, logs, backups, exports) is stored in the **same folder as Sanchay.exe**. This means your data is portable — copy the entire Sanchay folder to another machine and all your records come with it.

- *data\sanchay.db* — SQLite database (all your records)
- *logs\sanchay.log* — rotating application log
- *backups* — database backup files
- *exports* — generated PDF / Excel / CSV reports

■ Tip

Before uninstalling, always take a manual backup via Settings → Backup so you don't lose data.

3. First Run — Setup Wizard

On the very first launch, Sanchay runs a **Setup Wizard** to create the administrator account and your first organisation.

3.1 Setup Steps

Step 1	Welcome screen — click Start Setup.
Step 2	Enter Admin credentials: username, full name, email, and a strong password.
Step 3	Enter your first Organisation name and a short code (e.g. ACME / ACM).
Step 4	Review the summary and click Finish.

■ Note

The Setup Wizard runs only once. After completion, you will always see the Login screen. If you forget your admin password, contact your system administrator.

4. Logging In

After the first-run setup (or on every subsequent launch), Sanchay shows the **Login screen**.

- Enter your **Username** and **Password**.
- Click **Login** or press **Enter**.
- The application opens to the **Dashboard**.

■ Security

Passwords are hashed with bcrypt (12 rounds). Sessions expire after 8 hours of inactivity. All failed logins are recorded in the audit log.

5. Dashboard

The Dashboard is the home screen, visible immediately after login. It gives a live snapshot of your asset inventory.

5.1 Stat Cards

- **Total Assets** — count of all registered assets
- **Available** — assets not currently issued
- **Issued** — assets currently with a person
- **Overdue** — issued assets past their return date (highlighted in red)
- **Under Maintenance** — assets marked for service

■ Tip

Click any stat card to jump directly to the filtered asset list for that status.

5.2 Recent Activity

The Recent Activity panel shows the last 10 events — new assets, issues, returns, and logins — with timestamps and the user who performed them.

6. Organisations & Departments

Sanchay supports multiple organisations under one installation, each with its own departments. Navigate via **Sidebar** → **Organisation**.

6.1 Managing Organisations

- Click **+ New Organisation** (or **Ctrl+N**) to add one.
- Fill in: Name, Code (unique short identifier, e.g. ACME), Type, and Address.
- Click the **edit icon** on any row to update details.
- Deactivate an organisation to hide it from dropdowns without deleting its data.

6.2 Managing Departments

- Navigate to **Sidebar** → **Departments**.
- Each department belongs to an organisation and can have a parent department (for hierarchical structures like divisions → teams).
- Departments appear in asset and person forms for assignment.

7. Managing People

The People module manages everyone who can be assigned an asset. Navigate via **Sidebar** → **People**.

7.1 Person Types

- **Employee** — permanent or contractual staff
- **Student** — for educational institutions
- **Contractor** — third-party vendors or consultants
- **Candidate** — interview or temporary access

7.2 Adding a Person

- Click **+ New Person** (or **Ctrl+N**).
- Fill in the three tabs: **Basic Info** (name, email, phone), **Assignment** (department, type, employee ID), and **Notes**.
- Click **Save**.

7.3 Search & Filter

- Use the **Search bar** (Ctrl+F) to find by name, email, or ID.
- Use the **Type** tab (Employee / Student / Contractor / Candidate) to filter.
- Use the **Status** filter to show Active or Inactive persons.

8. Asset Categories

Categories organise your assets into a hierarchy (e.g. Electronics → Laptops). Navigate via **Sidebar** → **Categories**.

- Click **+ New Category** to create one.
- Optionally assign a **Parent Category** for nested hierarchies.
- Set a **Depreciation Rate** (%) for financial tracking.
- Categories appear in the Asset form and all reports.

9. Assets

The Assets module is the core of Sanchay. Every item you want to track — laptops, projectors, vehicles, tools — is an asset. Navigate via **Sidebar** → **Assets**.

9.1 Registering an Asset

Click **+ New Asset** (or **Ctrl+N**). The form has three tabs:

- **Identity** — Name, Asset Code (auto-generated or manual), Category, Organisation, Department, Serial Number, Model, Manufacturer, Location.
- **Specs** — Description, condition (New / Good / Fair / Poor / Damaged), status (Available / Issued / Maintenance / Retired / Lost).
- **Financial** — Purchase date, Purchase price, Warranty expiry date, Depreciation rate.

9.2 Asset List

- Use the **Search bar** to find assets by name, code, or serial number.
- Filter by **Status**, **Category**, or **Department** using the dropdowns.
- The **stat pills** at the top show counts per status at a glance.
- Click any row to open the **Asset Detail** dialog — full metadata, colour-coded warranty status, and complete issue history.

9.3 Asset Statuses

Status	Meaning
Available	Ready to be issued
Issued	Currently with a person
Maintenance	Undergoing repair or service
Retired	Decommissioned, no longer in use
Lost	Reported missing

10. Issue & Return Assets

The transaction workflow records who has which asset and when it must be returned. Navigate via **Sidebar** → **Issue Asset** or **Return Asset**.

10.1 Issuing an Asset

- Go to **Sidebar** → **Issue Asset**.
- Left panel: search and select the asset to issue (only Available assets appear).
- Right panel: search and select the person receiving it.
- Set the **Expected Return Date** (optional but recommended).
- Add any **Remarks** and click **Issue Asset**.
- The asset status changes to **Issued** automatically.

10.2 Returning an Asset

- Go to **Sidebar** → **Return Asset**.
- Search and select the active issue record.
- Set the **Return Condition** (Good / Fair / Poor / Damaged).
- Add remarks and click **Return Asset**.
- The asset status reverts to **Available**.

10.3 Transaction History

Navigate to **Sidebar** → **Transactions** to see the full history with four tabs:

- **Active** — currently issued assets
- **Overdue** — issues past the expected return date
- **All Issues** — complete issue log with date filter
- **Returns** — complete return log

■ Quick Return

On the Active or Overdue tabs, click the **Return** button on any row to return an asset inline — without navigating to the Return page.

11. Reports

Navigate to **Sidebar** → **Reports**. Sanchay offers six built-in report types, all exportable to PDF, Excel, and CSV.

11.1 Available Reports

Report	Description	Export
Asset Inventory	All assets with status, condition, price, warranty	PDF · Excel · CSV
Department Assets	Assets grouped by department with totals	PDF · Excel · CSV
Issue History	All issue records with date-range filter	PDF · Excel · CSV
Return History	All returns with condition on return	PDF · Excel · CSV
Overdue Assets	Active issues past expected return date	PDF · Excel · CSV
Person Holdings	Active asset holdings per person	PDF · Excel · CSV

11.2 Generating a Report

- Select a **Report Type** from the card grid.
- Use the **filter bar** to narrow by date range, department, or status.
- The **preview table** updates live as you change filters.
- Click **Export PDF**, **Export Excel**, or **Export CSV**.
- The file saves to the **exports** folder and the folder opens automatically.

12. Settings

Navigate to **Sidebar** → **Settings**. The Settings panel has three tabs.

12.1 General Settings

- **Asset Code Prefix** — prefix for auto-generated asset codes (e.g. AST-).
- **Organisation Name** — displayed in report headers.
- **Theme** — Light or Dark (planned for future release).
- **Auto-Backup** — enable and set interval (daily).

12.2 Audit Log

The Audit Log tab shows a searchable, read-only record of every action performed in the system — who did what, and when. Entries cannot be edited or deleted.

12.3 About

Displays application version, build info, and database statistics (table counts, DB size).

13. User Management

Admin only. Navigate to **Sidebar** → **Users**.

- Click **+ New User** to create an account.
- Set the **Role** (Admin / Manager / Operator / Viewer).
- Use the **toggle** to activate or deactivate a user.
- Click **Change Password** to reset a user's password.
- Your own account cannot be deactivated.

13.1 Roles & Permissions

Role	Assets	Issue/Return	Reports	Users	Backup
Admin	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Manager	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Operator	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
Viewer	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗

14. Backup & Restore

Admin only. Navigate to **Sidebar** → **Backup**.

14.1 Creating a Backup

- Click **Create Backup Now**.
- A timestamped `.db` file is saved to the **backups** folder.
- The backup list below shows all available backups with size and date.

14.2 Restoring a Backup

- Select a backup from the list.
- Click **Restore**. A confirmation dialog will appear.
- Type CONFIRM and click OK.
- The application restarts with the restored database.

■ Warning

Restoring overwrites your current database. Always create a fresh backup before restoring an older one.

14.3 Deleting a Backup

- Select a backup from the list and click **Delete**.
- Deleted backups cannot be recovered.

15. Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + N	New record (on any list page)
F5	Refresh current list
Ctrl + F	Focus the search bar
Del	Delete selected row
Escape	Cancel / close dialog

16. Troubleshooting

Problem: App does not launch

Solution: Check the logs\sanchay.log file next to Sanchay.exe for error details. Ensure you have write permission to the installation folder.

Problem: Setup Wizard does not appear

Solution: The wizard runs only on first launch (when no database exists). If data\sanchay.db exists, the login screen will show instead.

Problem: Login fails with correct credentials

Solution: Passwords are case-sensitive. If you have forgotten the admin password, restore a backup or contact your administrator.

Problem: Reports show no data

Solution: Ensure the filter date range covers the period you expect. Clear all filters (click Reset) and try again.

Problem: Export folder does not open

Solution: The exports\ folder is next to Sanchay.exe. Navigate there manually in File Explorer.

Problem: Database is corrupt after a crash

Solution: Use Backup → Restore to load the most recent clean backup. Backups are stored in the backups\ folder next to Sanchay.exe.

Problem: Overdue count seems wrong

Solution: Overdue status is synced on startup. Restart the application to trigger a fresh sync.

17. Uninstalling Sanchay

- Open **Windows Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed Apps**.
- Search for **Sanchay** and click **Uninstall**.
- The uninstaller asks: *Do you want to keep your data?*
- Click **Yes** to keep database, backups, and exports.
- Click **No** to remove everything.

■ Tip

Always choose Yes to keep data and take a manual backup first. You can delete the leftover folder manually later if needed.